Tesla, Inc.

TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	$403.82 ▲ 1.00%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$440.00	$297.38 – $498.83	$1.60T

TSLA: Stuck in Range as EV Credit Fight Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA bounced +1% today after four straight down days — nothing company-specific drove it, this looks like a sector-wide risk-on move (Consumer Discretionary ETF up 2.4%, the best performer on the board). Translation: Tesla rode the market's coattails, it didn't lead.
- The real tell is in the options market — someone bought $190M+ of near-term puts at the $407-$412 strikes (puts = bets that stock falls). That's not retail noise; that's institutional money hedging or betting against a near-term pop above $410.

WHY IT MATTERS

Tesla is stuck at the 53% mark of its 52-week range, which tells you the market can't decide if this is a car company (worth maybe $200) or an AI/robotics platform (worth $500+). The unusual put activity clustered right at current prices suggests smart money thinks $410 is a ceiling for now — someone's willing to spend big to bet the stock doesn't break out this month. Combined with zero insider buying and no catalyst-level news, the setup screams "wait for a better entry." The bigger picture: Tesla's narrative is in a transition period where the old EV growth story is fading (subsidies rolling off) and the new autonomy/robotics story isn't generating revenue yet — that gap is dangerous for a stock trading at ~165x forward earnings.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The biggest overhang is the fate of the $7,500 federal EV tax credit under the current administration — it was effectively killed for new purchases in late 2025, and Tesla's U.S. demand has been softer because of it. On the positive side, the administration's push to loosen federal autonomous vehicle rules (NHTSA is drafting a framework that would preempt state-by-state restrictions) is a direct tailwind for Robotaxi — if that framework drops in Q1, TSLA could re-rate higher fast. Also watch China tariff talks: Tesla's Shanghai factory and battery supply chain mean any escalation on rare earths or auto component tariffs cuts both ways for margins.

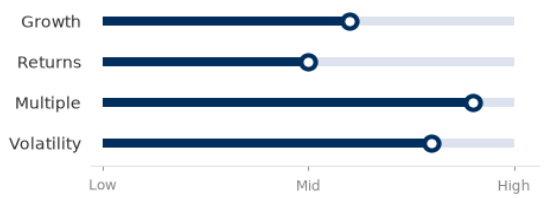
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~165x forward earnings, investors are paying $165 for every $1 of profit Tesla is expected to make next year — Ford trades at 8x, Toyota at 10x. That premium only makes sense if you believe Robotaxi and Optimus turn into real revenue lines within 2-3 years. Right now you're paying a software company multiple for a business that still makes 80%+ of its money selling cars with shrinking margins — that's the central tension.

Key Data

Price (USD)	**$403.82**
12M Price Target	**$440.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+9.0%**
Market Cap	**$1.60T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$112M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$135M**
FY2026E EPS	**$2.45**
FY2027E EPS	**$3.60**
Fwd P/E	**164.8x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

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PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$445.00**	$410.00	**$375.00**
6 Months	**$520.00**	$430.00	**$340.00**
1 Year	**$600.00**	$440.00	**$300.00**
2 Years	**$750.00**	$480.00	**$250.00**
5 Years	**$1200.00**	$650.00	**$200.00**
10 Years	**$2500.00**	$900.00	**$150.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+2.4%) and Financials (+1.9%) leading — classic risk-on behavior, likely tied to easing rate expectations and strong consumer data. Materials up on China trade optimism.

COOLING OFF: No defensive sectors in the top movers today, which tells you money is leaving safety and chasing growth — but Tesla isn't getting the full benefit of that rotation.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing into cyclicals broadly, but TSLA's underperformance vs. the Cons. Disc. ETF (+1% vs +2.4%) suggests investors prefer other discretionary names right now — possibly retail and travel over EVs.

RELATED PLAY: If the AV regulatory framework drops, the picks-and-shovels winners are LiDAR/sensor makers and chip suppliers (NVDA for inference, MBLY for ADAS) — those move before TSLA re-rates.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GM (General Motors): Benefiting from the "boring auto" trade — profitable, cheap, less exposed to the AV hype cycle, and their Cruise restart story is quietly developing.
- RIVN (Rivian): Any day the EV sector gets risk-on love, Rivian moves 2x Tesla because it's smaller and more shorted.

TSLA CONTEXT: Tesla is lagging its own sector today and trading in the middle of its 52-week range — that's a stock looking for a catalyst, not one leading the market. Until there's news on Robotaxi expansion, FSD unsupervised approval, or Q4 delivery numbers, expect it to drift with the tape rather than lead it.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the long-term story but the near-term setup is unattractive with heavy put buying and no catalyst.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this is a high-volatility name where position sizing matters more than entry timing; don't let it become 10% of your book even if it rips.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for $370-385, which is where it bounced earlier this fall. The unusual put activity suggests $410 is capped near-term, so chasing here is a bad risk/reward.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is Robotaxi hitting 5+ cities and federal AV preemption rules becoming law.

WHEN TO BAIL: If auto gross margins (ex-credits) drop below 15%, or if Robotaxi expansion stalls through Q2 2026, the thesis is broken — get out.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is owning a profitable traditional automaker like GM or Toyota alongside — if Tesla's premium compresses, those gain share. Or just keep the position small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't ruin your month.

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